Snoonu Hackathon | Product Strategy Plan | Case Three

Team: 22 - Snoonunation

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Last updated: Jan 17, 2026

Feature Name: Snoonu Merchant Intelligence Platform

Key Goal of Feature: To transform Snoonu's merchant portal from a passive reporting and notification interface into an intelligent growth platform that converts business data and market trends into clear, actionable decisions, optimized advertising strategies and incentive-driven service improvements for merchants.

Market Context, Problem & Benchmark

1. Market Context

Snoonu operates as a multi-vertical super app. The merchant portal primarily functions as an operational interface that delivers order notifications, basic performance statistics and access to campaign tools. Although merchants receive large volumes of data about their business performance, this information is presented in raw and fragmented form. Merchants are to independently interpret metrics, identify issues and design growth strategies. In reality, most merchants do not have the time or analytical capability to convert statistics into structured business decisions. As a result, the portal is used as a notification system rather than a platform for strategic growth management.

The problem occurs continuously and influences core activities such as inventory planning, pricing, advertising, and service quality management. From a platform perspective, this creates structural inefficiencies. Merchant revenue growth remains suboptimal, customer experience becomes inconsistent, adoption of paid growth tools is limited and operational support costs increase. Over time, this weakens merchant retention and reduces Snoonu's ability to position itself as a long-term business partner rather than a transactional delivery platform.

2. Problem

The central problem is that Snoonu merchants receive vendor-specific data but not decisions. The current system provides statistics without context, prioritization or guidance on what actions should be taken and why. The merchant experience breaks down because performance metrics are scattered across different views, trends are not explained, business risks are not highlighted and there is no clear connection between operational actions and financial outcomes. Advertising tools require manual configuration without intelligent recommendations and feedback from the platform is not supported by structured incentives to drive improvement. These issues originate from a portal design focused on operational reporting rather than business optimization, the absence of analytical and predictive tooling, weak incentive alignment and limited merchant familiarity with data-driven decision making. The downstream impact is significant. Customers experience higher cancellation rates, delayed deliveries and inconsistent quality. For Snoonu, this results in lower advertising revenue, higher merchant churn and reduced brand trust as a professional commerce platform.

3. Benchmark & Existing Solutions

Currently, Snoonu offers basic dashboards and notification-based feedback mechanisms. These solutions expose information but do not translate it into prioritized, actionable business guidance. Examples from other international platforms have moved beyond this model. Uber Eats provides restaurant performance analytics, automated campaign recommendations and operational benchmarking. DoorDash offers merchant health scoring, predictive forecasting and tier-based incentive programs. Swiggy and Zomato deploy AI-assisted promotion tools and structured merchant growth platforms. Shopify integrates profit simulations, demand forecasting, and AI-driven business recommendations directly into its merchant interface. Leading platforms are transitioning from presenting data to delivering intelligence. While Snoonu already possesses the necessary data infrastructure, it currently lacks the decision layer that transforms information into measurable business outcomes. This gap represents both the core problem and a strategic opportunity for platform differentiation.

Vision & Goals

1. Product Vision

The vision is to transform Snoonu's merchant portal into an intelligent business partner that actively guides merchants toward better operational decisions, sustainable growth and higher profitability. Instead of reacting to performance metrics after problems occur, merchants should be able to anticipate demand, optimize promotions and improve service quality through clear, real-time recommendations generated directly within their existing workflow. Success will change merchant behavior from passive monitoring to proactive optimization. Merchants will no longer rely on intuition but will consistently act on data-driven insights, leading to more structured decision-making.

2. Jobs To Be Done for Users

- As a merchant, I want to receive simple, actionable guidance rather than complex statistics, so that I can focus on running my business instead of analyzing data.
- As a merchant, I want to understand which products to prioritize, which promotions to run, and how to price and discount items profitably, so that I can increase revenue without harming my margins.
- As a merchant, I want to identify operational weaknesses such as stock availability, preparation delays, and customer complaints early, so that I can improve service quality and protect my reputation on the platform.

3. Goals for Snoonu

This solution is designed to directly improve Snoonu's core marketplace metrics, including merchant retention, average order volume per merchant, advertising product adoption and customer satisfaction scores. In addition, it enables Snoonu to increase high-margin revenue streams such as sponsored listings and campaign spending by lowering the barrier for merchants to participate in advertising and promotion activities. Beyond quantifiable metrics, the platform strengthens Snoonu's strategic positioning as a growth partner by improving brand trust and creating a scalable foundation for long-term ecosystem development.

Solution

1. Solution Overview

The proposed solution is an AI-powered merchant intelligence layer integrated directly into Snoonu's existing merchant portal. It functions as a decision-support and growth optimization platform that continuously analyzes vendor-specific performance data **alongside market-wide demand trends** to generate clear, actionable business guidance. The solution lives inside the current Snoonu merchant interface as a dedicated "Growth & Insights" dashboard. End-to-end, the platform collects operational, commercial, and customer experience data, processes it through analytical and predictive models, and translates the results into prioritized actions such as inventory adjustments, campaign recommendations, pricing and discount strategies, and service quality improvements. These actions are reinforced through a built-in feedback and reward system that incentivizes merchants to adopt best practices and continuously improve performance.

2. Key Features

Feature Name	**Description (How it works)**
AI Insights & Recommendation Engine	This feature continuously analyzes merchant-level performance data, including orders, cancellations, ratings, inventory availability, and campaign results, together with market-level demand trends. It converts this data into prioritized, easy-to-understand recommendations that highlight what actions the merchant should take, why they matter, and the expected business impact in terms of revenue. Merchants can instantly get an implementable plan to improve the desired metrics.
Marketing Manager	This feature provides AI-driven marketing recommendations tailored to each merchant's products, demand trends, and past campaign performance. It also includes a tier-based *Snoonu Stars* program, where high-performing merchants unlock influencer and promotional access, with benefits increasing from Gold to Platinum.
Performance Feedback System	This feature monitors service quality indicators such as preparation time, cancellation rates and customer ratings, and provides structured feedback when issues arise. Merchants earn points and tier upgrades for resolving problems and maintaining high standards, unlocking incentives such as ad credits and platform benefits.
Merchant Score Simulator	This feature allows merchants to preview how improvements in specific metrics, such as delivery time or customer ratings, would affect their overall platform score and tier level. It creates transparency and motivates continuous optimization.

Impact & Metrics

1. Impact

This solution directly solves merchants' core job of making fast, confident business decisions that increase revenue and service quality without requiring manual data analysis. By converting operational data and market trends into prioritized and actionable recommendations, merchants can optimize inventory, pricing, promotions, and service performance from a single interface. The solution is uniquely suited to Snoonu's context because it builds on data that already exists across the platform, including orders, customer behavior, delivery performance, and campaign results, and integrates seamlessly into the current merchant portal.

2. Metrics

The primary North Star metric for this solution is the merchant action adoption rate, defined as the percentage of system-generated recommendations that are implemented by merchants. This metric captures whether the platform is successfully changing behavior and reducing decision friction. An increase in action adoption is expected to drive measurable improvements in Snoonu's key business metrics, including higher campaign participation, increased average orders per merchant, improved customer ratings, lower merchant-caused cancellations and stronger long-term merchant retention. Supporting metrics include merchant revenue growth, advertising revenue per merchant, order fulfillment time, complaint rate, catalog availability accuracy, frequency of repeat customers, and average tier progression rate within the reward system.

Technical Implementation & Scalability

1. Technical Implementation

The implementation builds on Snoonu's existing data foundation by collecting the signals merchants already generate, including orders, cancellations, inventory updates, campaign performance, and operational SLA events, into a centralized store. A lightweight ETL process aggregates this raw information into merchant-level features on an hourly or daily cadence and serves them through modular services. A Scoring Service computes the merchant score and tier using configurable weights, while a Recommendation Service converts patterns into prioritized actions such as restock warnings, pricing gaps, catalog fixes, or missed sales opportunities. This keeps the MVP easy to deploy because it sits on top of the current merchant portal and core ordering flow, adding intelligence without changing how orders are processed. We use a hybrid AI approach that stays practical and trustworthy. A secure large language model turns the score breakdown and performance changes into clear explanations, and it also generates drafts for campaigns, promotional copy, and customer-facing messages when needed. To keep outputs reliable, every AI suggestion is checked by a rules-based guardrail layer that enforces business constraints, verifies required inputs, and blocks risky actions such as aggressive discounting unless the merchant explicitly confirms. On top of this, simple forecasting and anomaly detection help merchants act earlier by flagging expected demand spikes, unusual cancellation trends, or stockout risk before they impact customers.

Scalability Plan

The platform will initially be rolled out to a controlled pilot group of food merchants to validate recommendation accuracy, usability, and performance impact. Following successful validation, it will be gradually expanded to the broader food merchant base and later to grocery and service verticals. From an internal operations perspective, the system reduces manual workload for merchant success teams by partly automating performance monitoring and feedback generation. Support teams benefit from earlier detection of service issues, enabling proactive intervention rather than reactive troubleshooting. Over time, this reduces operational costs associated with repeated merchant training and issue resolution. The solution generates long-term efficiency gains by increasing adoption of self-serve advertising tools, reducing cancellation-related customer support costs, and improving merchant retention, which lowers acquisition expenses. Beyond the MVP, the platform can be expanded to include automated campaign execution for low-risk scenarios, vertical-specific optimization models, and ecosystem-level insights for internal strategy teams.

Appendix

- **Working Prototype Link:** https://aunashraf12.github.io/demo/index.html

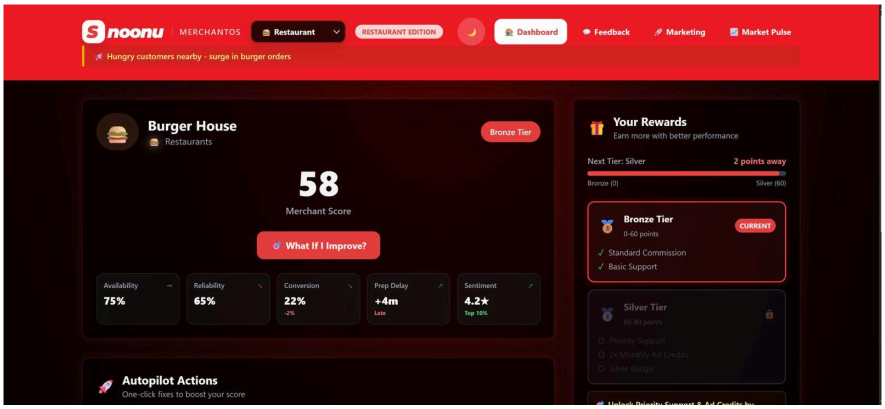

Figure 1: Main Dashboard of MerchantOS

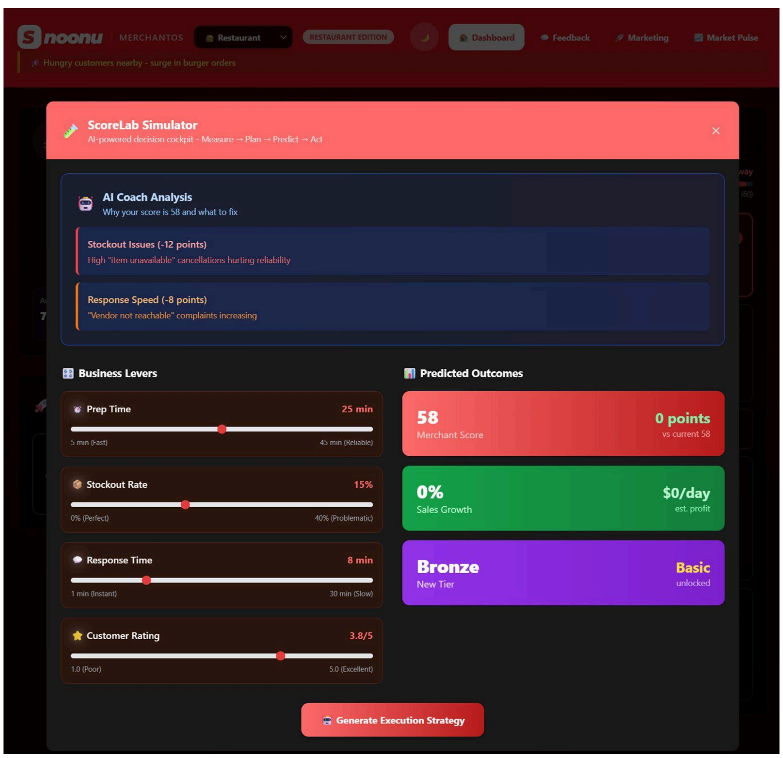

FIgure 2: Merchant Score Simulator

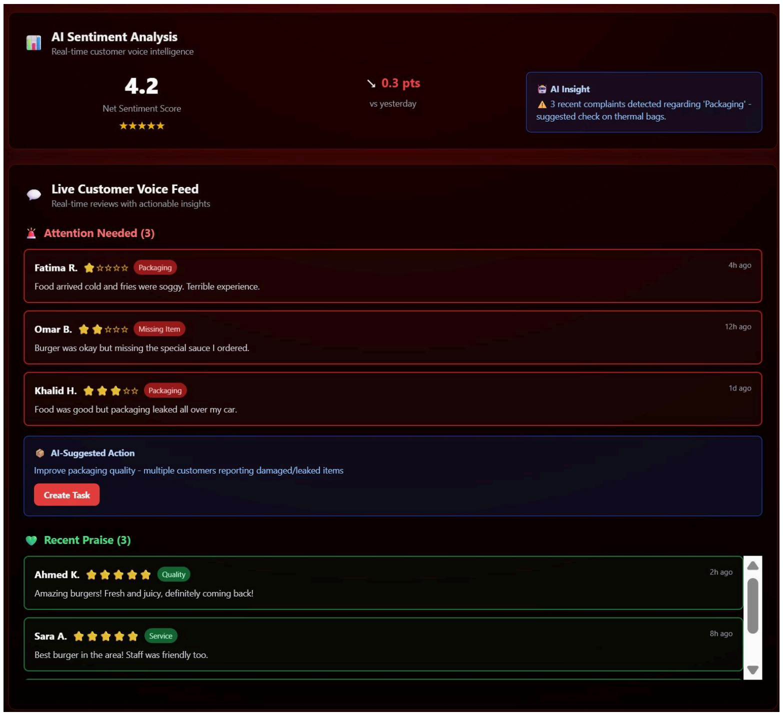

Figure 3: Performance Feedback System

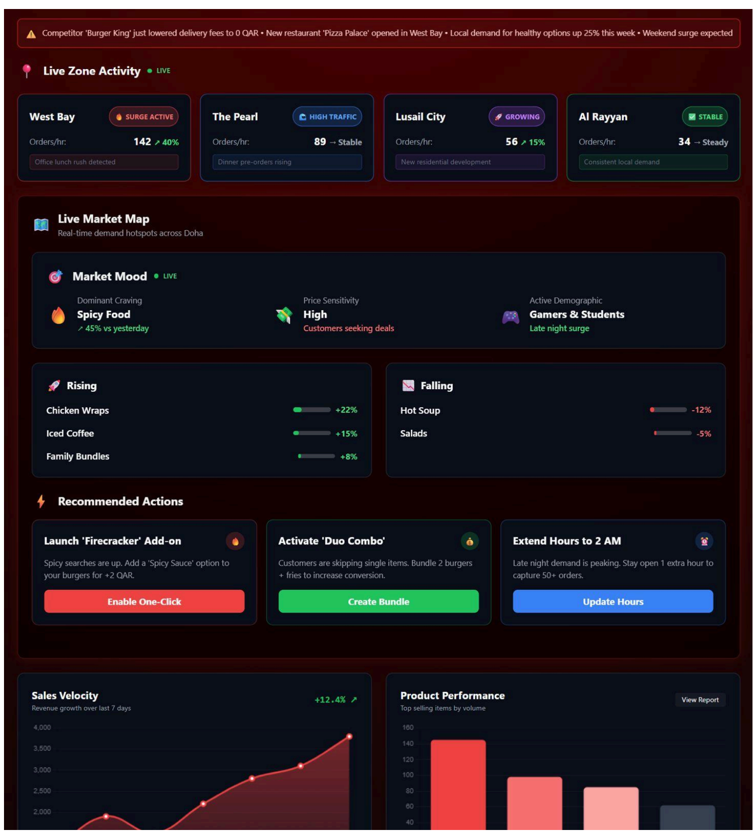

Figure 4: Market Pulse Tab